

Atelier

A premium Shopify theme design specification — visual system, component library, page architecture, motion language, and implementation intent.

PREPARED FOR IMPLEMENTATION VIA CLAUDE CODE · NOT A CODING DELIVERABLE

POSITIONING	VERTICALS	PRINCIPLES
\$350–\$500 tier, alongside Prestige, Impulse, Broadcast	Fashion, luxury, beauty, furniture, jewelry, electronics, lifestyle	Restraint, whitespace, tactility, speed, conversion without noise

1 · Design Philosophy

Atelier is built on a single conviction: *luxury is the absence of noise*. Premium themes fail when they decorate; they succeed when they edit. Every decision below removes friction, reduces visual competition with product photography, and lets merchandise carry the page.

- **Photography is the hero.** The UI is a warm-neutral frame. Chrome never uses saturated color; the only saturation on any page comes from products.
- **Whitespace is the brand.** Section spacing of 96–160px signals confidence. Cramped layouts read as discount; air reads as price.
- **One accent, used rarely.** A bronze accent appears on fewer than 5% of elements — links, active states, sale prices. Scarcity makes it feel deliberate.
- **Typography does the luxury work.** A quiet serif display (Marcellus) against a precise grotesque (Instrument Sans) — the pairing found in editorial fashion, not SaaS.
- **Motion is physical, not decorative.** Everything eases like a weighted object (Apple/Linear-style ease-out curves). Nothing bounces, spins, or pulses.
- **Conversion through clarity.** Fewer, larger, better-placed CTAs beat urgency widgets. Trust is built with typography and order, not countdown clutter.

- **Neutral by default, brandable by tokens.** Every vertical (jewelry to electronics) is served by swapping 6 tokens — never by redesign.

2 · Color System

The palette is warm-neutral (hue ~75° in oklch, chroma ≤ 0.015 for surfaces). Warm neutrals photograph well beside skin tones, wood, metals, and fabric — the dominant materials of the target verticals. Accents share one lightness/chroma family so any subset stays harmonious.

LIGHT MODE (DEFAULT)

	Token	HEX	Why it exists
	Background	#FAF9F7	Warm off-white; pure #FFF reads clinical beside product photography.
	Surface	#FFFFFF	Elevated planes (drawers, modals, popovers) — one step brighter than page.
	Card	#F3F1EC	Recessed tint for image placeholders, quiet cards, alternate sections.
	Border	#E7E3DC	Hairline dividers; strong enough to structure, quiet enough to ignore.
	Primary / Text Primary	#1C1B18	Warm ink. Primary buttons and headlines share it — luxury brands use ink, not brand-blue, as the action color.
	Text Secondary	#57534A	Body copy, descriptions — 7.9:1 contrast on Background.
	Text Muted	#8A857B	Captions, meta, kickers — never below 14px or 4.5:1 in running text.
	Secondary / Accent — Bronze	#8A6D4B	oklch(0.55 0.06 75). Links, active states, editorial accents. Metallic without a gradient.
	Accent 2 — Sage (optional)	#5C6F5E	oklch(0.52 0.05 150) — same lightness/chroma family as bronze; badges, in-stock cues, beauty/home verticals.
	Success	#2E7D5B	Added-to-cart, in-stock, form success. Muted green — no neon.
	Warning	#A66A1F	Low stock, backorder. Amber tuned to the warm palette.
	Error / Sale	#B3402E	Form errors and sale prices. Brick red — urgent without discount-store scream.
	Info	#3B6EA5	Shipping notices, informational banners. Desaturated slate blue.
	Overlay	#1C1B18 · 45%	Scrim behind drawers/modals — warm ink, never pure black.

DARK MODE — “GALLERY AT NIGHT”

Not inverted light mode: a warm charcoal environment where product imagery glows. Surfaces get *lighter* with elevation (shadows are invisible on dark ground, so elevation is expressed tonally + with 1px inner borders).

	Background	#141311	Warm near-black (oklch 0.19 0.006 80); pure #000 crushes photos.
	Surface	#1D1B18	Cards, header, drawers.
	Card / Elevated	#26231F	Modals, dropdowns — highest tonal step.
	Border	#33302A	Hairlines; plus inset highlight rgba(255,255,255,0.04) on elevated planes.
	Text Primary	#F1EEE8	Warm ivory — softer on OLED than #FFF.
	Text Secondary	#B5AFA4	Body copy; muted #7D786E for meta only.
	Accent — Bronze (dark)	#C2A379	Lightened two steps to hold 4.5:1 on Surface. Status colors likewise: #4EA382 / #D08A3A / #D96A55 / #7AA3CC.

HOVER, GRADIENT, GLASS

- **Hover rule:** darken fills 6% (ink button → #33302A), tint quiet surfaces with Card color; never change hue on hover.
- **Gradients:** two only. Scrim `linear(180°, rgba(28,27,24,0) 40%, rgba(28,27,24,0.55))` for text-on-image legibility; Sheen `linear(135°, #FAF9F7, #F0EDE6)` for quiet section backgrounds. No decorative color gradients anywhere.
- **Glassmorphism:** one sanctioned use — sticky header over hero: `rgba(250,249,247,0.82) + blur(16px) saturate(1.4)`, hairline bottom border. Optional second use on mobile sticky ATC bar. Nowhere else.

3 · Typography

Marcellus (display) + **Instrument Sans** (everything else). Marcellus is a single-weight Roman-capital serif — flared terminals and classical proportions give it engraved-invitation elegance without Didone fragility, and it holds up across jewelry and electronics alike. Instrument Sans is a contemporary grotesque with slightly condensed metrics and true optical sizing: precise, quiet, and unassociated with SaaS defaults. Two families, three loaded weights — premium *and* fast. Prices use Instrument Sans with `font-variant-numeric: tabular-nums` so totals never jitter as quantities change; no third font needed.

Style	Face / weight	Desktop → Mobile	Line height	Tracking	Use
Display / H1	Marcellus 400	<code>c1amp(40 → 64px)</code>	1.08	+0.01em	Hero, page titles
H2	Marcellus 400	<code>c1amp(30 → 42px)</code>	1.15	+0.01em	Section headings
H3	Marcellus 400	<code>c1amp(24 → 30px)</code>	1.25	0	Product title (PDP), card group titles
H4	Instrument Sans 600	20 → 18px	1.3	0	Drawer titles, modal titles
H5	Instrument Sans 600	16px	1.4	0	Card titles, accordion headers
H6 / Kicker	Instrument Sans 500	12px caps	1.4	+0.16em	Eyebrows above headings, meta labels
Body Large	Instrument Sans 400	18px	1.6	0	Intros, editorial copy
Body	Instrument Sans 400	15px	1.65	0	Descriptions, general copy
Small	Instrument Sans 400	13px	1.5	0	Helper text, shipping notes
Caption	Instrument Sans 500	11px caps	1.4	+0.12em	Badges, image captions
Button	Instrument Sans 500	13px caps	1	+0.12em	All CTAs — caps + tracking = engraved-label feel
Navigation	Instrument Sans 500	14px	1	+0.04em	Header links, mega menu
Price	Instrument Sans 500, tabular-nums	15px card / 20px PDP	1	+0.02em	All prices; compare-at struck in Muted

Responsive rule: display sizes use `c1amp()` against viewport width; body sizes are fixed. Body text never below 15px; legal/meta never below 11px. Load strategy: `font-display: swap` with metric-matched system fallbacks (Georgia for Marcellus, Helvetica for Instrument Sans) to eliminate CLS.

4 · Grid, Spacing, Radius & Elevation

GRID

- Desktop 1440+: 12 columns, 24px gutter, container **1360px** max (wide sections) / **1200px** (content); page gutter 48px

RADIUS

- Buttons & inputs: **2px** (near-sharp = luxury default; merchant slider 0→999)
- Cards & images: **4px** (radius-sm)

- Laptop 1280: 12 cols, 24px gutter, gutter 40px
- Tablet 768: 8 cols, 20px gutter, gutter 32px
- Mobile 390–430: 4 cols, 16px gutter, gutter 20px
- Full-bleed sections (hero, banners) escape the container; text within them re-aligns to it
- Prose measure capped at 68ch

SPACING — 8PT SCALE

4 · 8 · 12 · 16 · 24 · 32 · 48 · 64 · 96 · 128 · 160

- Within a component: 4–16
- Between related elements: 16–32
- Card padding: 24 (20 mobile)
- Section vertical rhythm: 96–128 desktop, 64–80 mobile; 160 before footer

- Drawers/modals: 8px (radius-md); popovers 8px
- Swatches, avatars, icon chips: 999 (pill/circle)
- Rule: imagery radius $\leq$ card radius so photos never look cropped by chrome

SHADOWS — WARM, LAYERED, LOW-ALPHA

- sm — 0 1px 2px rgba(28,27,24,.05)
- md — 0 2px 8px rgba(28,27,24,.06), 0 1px 2px rgba(28,27,24,.04)
- lg — 0 8px 28px rgba(28,27,24,.10), 0 2px 6px rgba(28,27,24,.05)
- float — 0 16px 48px rgba(28,27,24,.14), 0 4px 12px rgba(28,27,24,.06)
- modal — 0 24px 64px rgba(28,27,24,.18)
- dropdown — md + 1px border (border does the edge work)

Shadow color is warm ink, never pure black — this is what separates “soft luxury” from “Bootstrap gray”. No shadow exceeds 18% alpha.

5 · Component Specifications

Global state contract — every interactive component implements all seven states:

- **Hover:** 6% fill darken or underline reveal, 200ms ease-out. No hue shifts.
- **Active:** scale(0.98) + fill darken 10%, 120ms.
- **Focus-visible:** 2px bronze outline, 2px offset — never outline:none without replacement.
- **Disabled:** 40% opacity, cursor not-allowed; never remove from tab order silently.
- **Loading:** label fades to 0, 16px hairline spinner (1.5px stroke) fades in; width locked to prevent reflow.
- **Mobile:** minimum hit target 44×44px; hover states map to active states.
- **A11y:** visible label or aria-label, role, and announced state changes (aria-live for cart/quantity).

5.1 Header & Navigation

- **Announcement bar** — 36px, ink background, ivory Caption text, optional auto-rotating messages (6s, crossfade, pauses on hover/focus). Dismiss “x” persists via localStorage. One message at a time; never a marquee.
- **Header (sticky)** — 72px desktop / 60px mobile. Layout: nav left · wordmark center · utility icons right (search, account, wishlist, cart with count chip). Scrolled state: background Surface at 82% + blur(16px), hairline bottom border, height compresses to 60px over 250ms. Hides on scroll-down, reveals on scroll-up (translateY, 300ms).
- **Transparent header** — over heroes: ivory text + logo, no background; crossfades to solid on first scroll. Requires hero scrim for contrast (§2).
- **Mega menu** — full-width panel, Surface background, shadow-dropdown, opens 250ms fade+8px slide-down on 150ms hover-intent delay. Grid: 3–4 link columns (H6 kicker + nav links) + 1–2 promo image cards right. Keyboard: opens on Enter/Space, arrow-key traversal, Esc closes and returns focus.
- **Header search / predictive** — icon expands a full-width overlay panel (not a tiny inline field): 20px input, results appear after 2 chars grouped Products (image, title, price) / Collections / Pages / Articles, with “Search for ‘...’ →” as first row. Debounced 200ms; skeleton rows while loading; recent searches when empty. Esc closes; focus trapped.
- **Mobile navigation** — full-height left drawer, 88% width max 400px. Top-level links 18px Marcellus, 56px rows; chevron pushes a sub-panel sliding in from right (back header). Bottom block: account, currency/locale, dark-mode toggle, social. Scrim tap + swipe-left closes.

5.2 Commerce Surfaces

- **Product card** — 4:5 image on Card tint, 16px gap to text. Text: title (H5, 400 weight), muted vendor Caption above (optional), price below (Price style; sale = brick + struck compare-at in Muted). Hover: image crossfades to second photo (350ms), quick-add reveals as bottom-edge bar sliding up over image (“Add — \$148” or “Choose options”); card lifts shadow-sm→md. Badges top-left: Caption chips — “New” (ink on ivory), “Sale -20%” (ivory on brick), “Sold out” (Muted on Card, image at 60% opacity). Wishlist heart top-right, appears on hover (always visible on touch). Mobile: quick-add is a persistent 36px “+” chip, bottom-right of image.
- **Collection / category cards** — image (3:4 or square) + scrim + centered Marcellus title in ivory, or minimal variant: image with title + item count below-left. Hover: image scale 1.0→1.04 within overflow-hidden frame, 600ms ease-out.
- **Quick View** — 880px modal, gallery left / buy box right (mini-PDP: title, price, swatches, size, qty, ATC, “View full details” link). Opens 300ms scale 0.97→1 + fade. Mobile: becomes a bottom sheet at 92% height.

- **Cart drawer** — right drawer 440px, Surface, shadow-float, 400ms slide with expo ease. Anatomy top→bottom: header (“Cart · 3” + close), free-shipping progress bar (hairline track, ink fill, “\$22 away from free shipping” — turns Success with a check when reached), line items (88px image, title, variant Caption, qty stepper, price, remove), upsell strip (“Pairs well with” — 2 mini cards, one-tap add), footer: subtotal row, shipping note Small, primary Checkout button full-width, “View cart” ghost link. Item add animates in with 250ms fade+slide; removal collapses height 250ms. aria-live="polite" announces changes.
- **Cart page** — 2-column: items table left (borderless rows, hairline separators), sticky order-summary card right (Card tint, 24px padding): subtotal, discount field (collapsed behind “Add discount code” link), gift-wrap checkbox (+\$5), shipping estimator (country/zip → rates), checkout CTA, payment icons in grayscale, trust row (returns · secure checkout · support). Recommendations grid below.
- **Wishlist** — heart toggles with a single 300ms scale pulse (1→1.25→1); saved state = filled ink heart. Wishlist page reuses product-card grid with remove affordance. Header icon shows count chip.
- **Compare** — checkbox on card hover (“Compare”); floating bottom bar collects up to 4 (thumbnails + “Compare →”); compare page is a sticky-first-column table: image, price, rating, key metafields. Mobile: 2 products side-by-side, horizontal scroll.
- **Recently viewed** — standard product-card row, session-persistent, appears on PDP + cart page only. Auto-hides under 2 items.

5.3 Forms & Controls

- **Buttons** — height 48px (44 mobile), padding 0 28px, Button type style, radius token. *Primary*: ink fill / ivory text; hover #33302A. *Secondary*: Card fill / ink text, hairline border. *Outline*: transparent, 1px ink border; hover fills ink (300ms). *Ghost*: text-only with 1px underline offset 4px; hover: underline thickens to 2px. On-image buttons: ivory outline variant.
- **Inputs / select / textarea** — 48px, Surface fill, hairline border, radius token, 15px text; label above (Small, 500). Focus: border→ink + bronze focus ring. Error: brick border + 13px message with 16px icon below; success: subtle Success check inside right edge. Select uses a custom chevron popover on desktop, native picker on mobile. Floating labels are not used — visible labels beat them for a11y and clarity.
- **Checkbox / radio** — 20px, 1.5px border; checked = ink fill + ivory glyph, 150ms scale-in. Radio dot 8px. Labels are full clickable rows in filter contexts (44px row height).
- **Switch** — 44×24px track, pill; off = Border fill, on = ink; knob slides 200ms with slight squash. Used for dark mode, gift wrap, filter toggles.
- **Quantity selector** — 112×48px segmented: – / tabular value / +; buttons darken on hover, value editable, long-press repeats. Min/max disable ends at limits.

- **Variant picker** — buttons not dropdowns wherever ≤ 8 options. Size: 44px min square chips, hairline border; selected = ink border 1.5px + ink text; unavailable = diagonal strike + Muted (still clickable → “Notify me”). Selected value echoed in label: “Size — M”.
- **Color swatches** — 28px circles (32 on PDP), 2px whitespace ring between swatch and its selection ring; selected = 1.5px ink ring. Image-fill swatches for fabrics/finishes. Name on hover tooltip + echoed in label. Never color-only: label text always states the selection (color-blind safe).

5.4 PDP Modules

- **Product gallery** — desktop: vertical stacked images (scrolling column) with 8px gaps; thumbnail rail optional. Mobile: edge-to-edge swipe carousel, 4px progress dots (current = 16px pill). Video and 3D models inline with badge glyph.
- **Zoom** — desktop: click opens full-viewport lightbox (ivory ground, 1px close, arrows, pinch/scroll zoom to 2.5 $\times$); hover-pan magnify is off by default (fussy). Mobile: pinch within lightbox.
- **Accordion** — hairline top/bottom rules, H5 header rows 56px with thin “+” → “ $\times$ ” rotating 45° (250ms); panel height animates 300ms ease-out. One-open-at-a-time optional setting. Chevron variant available.
- **Tabs** — text tabs, Nav style, active = ink + 1.5px underline that slides between tabs (250ms). Overflow scrolls horizontally with edge fade. Tabs convert to accordion below 768px.
- **Reviews** — summary block: 40px Marcellus average, stars (thin-stroke, ink — never yellow), distribution bars (hairline tracks). Review cards: borderless, hairline separated; verified badge Caption in Success; photos as 64px thumbs opening lightbox. Write-review is a modal. Sort + photo-filter chips.
- **Size guide** — link beside size label opens modal: measurement table (hairline, sticky header), unit toggle cm/in, “how to measure” diagram placeholder.
- **Countdown timer** — tabular digits, Caption labels, hairline separators — editorial, not alarm-clock. Ends by hiding, never showing 00:00:00. Off by default.
- **Trust badges** — thin-stroke icon + Small text rows (shipping, returns, warranty, secure) — monochrome ink icons only; no colored padlock clip-art.

5.5 Content & Marketing Sections

- **Hero** — full-bleed image/video, 78vh desktop / 88vh mobile (min 560px), scrim, content on container grid: kicker → H1 (max 12 words) → subline → 1-2 CTAs. Text position setting (9-cell grid). Slow Ken-Burns scale 1.03 → 1 over 8s on load, once. **Split hero**: 50/50 image | Card-tint text panel. **Video hero**: muted loop, poster-first for LCP, pause control bottom-right (a11y).
- **Image with text** — 6/6 or 7/5 columns, 96px gap; text block vertically centered, max 44ch, kicker + H2 + body + ghost CTA. Alternating direction on repeat.

- **Image banner** — full-bleed, 480px, parallax at 0.85 scroll ratio (desktop only), centered Marcellus statement + ghost CTA.
- **Collection grid** — 2–4 columns of collection cards; “editorial” variant: one 2×2 feature + smalls.
- **Product slider** — cards at 4-up desktop with next-card peek (~15%), free-scroll with snap; hairline progress bar under, arrows top-right beside title. Mobile: 1.6 cards visible.
- **Testimonials** — single centered quote: 28px Marcellus italic-feel quote, name + role Caption, hairline stars; crossfade rotation 8s + dots. Alt: 3-up quiet Card-tint cards.
- **Brand logos** — “As seen in” Caption + grayscale logos at 45% opacity, hover 100%; single row, wraps on mobile.
- **Instagram feed** — square grid 4–6 up, gap 4px; hover shows scrim + thin glyph; header “@handle” link.
- **Newsletter** — Card-tint band, centered: kicker + H2 (“10% off your first order”) + single-line input+button combo (button inside field on desktop, stacked mobile) + 12px privacy note. Success swaps form for check + message, 300ms crossfade.
- **Blog cards** — 3:2 image, Caption date/tag, H5 title, 2-line excerpt, “Read →” ghost. Featured variant spans 2 columns.
- **FAQ** — accordion in 68ch column, optionally 2-column grouped by topic with sticky topic nav.
- **Timeline** — vertical hairline spine, bronze 8px dots, year in Marcellus, entries alternate sides (single side mobile). For brand-story pages.
- **Comparison table** — sticky header row with product images; hairline grid, check = thin ink check, dash for absent. First column sticky on mobile scroll.
- **Icons** — one family: 1.5px stroke, 24px grid, round caps (Lucide-style discipline). Never mixed weights; never filled + outlined together.
- **Pagination** — “Load more” outline button + “Showing 24 of 128” Small text (primary pattern); numbered pagination available: ghost numbers, active = ink underline.
- **Breadcrumb** — Small, Muted, “/” separators, current page in ink; truncates middle on mobile.
- **Footer** — ink background, ivory text. Rows: (1) 4 link columns + newsletter mini-form, (2) hairline rule (ivory 12%), (3) locale/currency selects, payment icons (outline style), social, legal Caption at 60% ivory. Massive 96px padding — footer whitespace is a luxury signal.
- **Back to top** — 44px circle, Surface + shadow-md, thin up arrow; appears after 2 viewports, bottom-right, above mobile sticky bars.

5.6 System States & Overlays

- **Skeletons** — Card-tint blocks matching real component geometry (image ratio, 2 text lines, price line); 1.8s shimmer sweep at 4% white; respects reduced-motion (static). Never spinners for content areas.

- **Loading indicator** — 16–24px circular hairline arc, 1.5px stroke, 900ms linear rotation. Page transitions: 2px ink progress bar under header.
- **Empty states** — centered: thin-stroke 48px glyph, H4 (“Your cart is waiting”), one Small line, one primary CTA (“Continue shopping”). Same pattern for cart, wishlist, search-no-results (plus popular-searches chips), account orders.
- **404** — full-height: giant Marcellus “404” at 8% opacity behind “Lost, beautifully.” H2, search field, links to bestsellers. Chrome stays; no illustration clip-art.
- **Maintenance / password page** — full-bleed brand image + centered logo, Marcellus one-liner, password input; newsletter capture optional.
- **Popup (email capture)** — 720px split modal: image left / offer right; fires at 20s or 40% scroll or exit intent, once per 14 days, never on first pageview of a session with UTM=email, never over checkout. Mobile: bottom sheet. Focus trapped, Esc + scrim close.
- **Cookie banner** — bottom-left floating card 360px (not full-width bar), shadow-float: Small copy, “Accept” primary / “Preferences” ghost. Doesn’t block reading; z-index below modals.
- **Age verification** — full-screen scrim + centered Card: logo, “Are you 21+?”, two buttons; blur 24px behind. Remembered 30 days.
- **Toast** — bottom-center chip, ink fill/ivory text, 300ms rise, auto-dismiss 4s, action link optional (“Added — View cart”). aria-live.

6 · Homepage Architecture



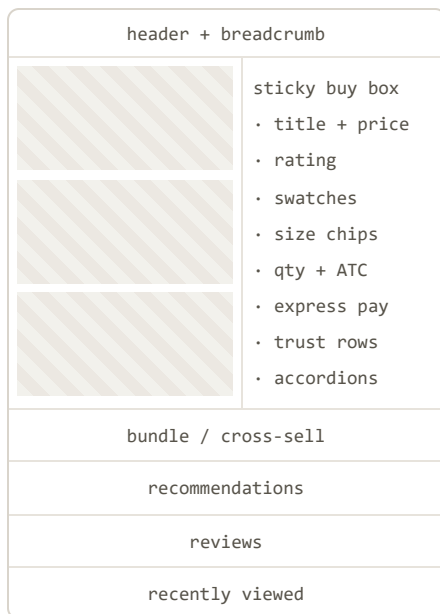
1. **Hero** — brand statement + primary path (“Shop New Arrivals”). One message, one CTA priority.
2. **Featured collections (3-up)** — immediate wayfinding; most visitors are category-driven, so navigation choices appear before persuasion.
3. **Best sellers (4-up grid + quick add)** — social proof through curation; best-converting SKUs get the first product impressions.
4. **Image banner (parallax)** — visual palate cleanser; resets attention between two product-dense zones and carries brand mood.
5. **New arrivals (slider)** — freshness signal for returning visitors; slider caps vertical cost.



6. **Testimonial** — placed after products so proof lands once desire exists.
7. **Video / brand story** — deepens justification for premium pricing right before the ask.
8. **Press logos** — borrowed authority, low height.
9. **Instagram** — community proof + UGC texture.
10. **Newsletter** — the exit ramp: captures non-buyers at the natural end of the scroll.

Rhythm: 128px between sections; 96px within grouped pairs (5→6); 160px before footer. The order alternates *navigate* → *buy* → *feel* so no two adjacent sections make the same demand — this cadence measurably lengthens scroll depth versus product-grid-only homepages. Background alternation: Background → Card-tint on sections 7 and 10 only.

7 · Product Page



- **Layout** — 7/5 split: stacked scrolling gallery left, **sticky buy box** right (sticks at header offset). The buyer scrolls imagery while the ATC never leaves view — the highest-leverage conversion mechanic on the page.
- **Buy box order** — vendor Caption → H3 title → price + rating row (“★ 4.8 · 214 reviews” anchors to reviews) → color swatches → size chips + size-guide link → quantity + **full-width primary ATC** → express checkout (Shop Pay) → shipping/stock line (“In stock — ships in 24h” Success dot; low stock = Warning “Only 3 left” with restraint) → trust icon rows → accordions: Description / Materials & Care / Shipping & Returns / FAQ.
- **ATC feedback** — button label morphs to spinner → “Added ✓” (Success fill, 800ms) → cart drawer slides open. Never navigate away.
- **Bundle / upsell** — “Complete the look”: 2–3 items with checkboxes + combined price + “Add selected”. Cross-sell also lives in the cart drawer (cheaper attention). Upsell (“upgrade to the set”) as a quiet radio above ATC when configured.

- **Variant behavior** — selection updates gallery (color-matched images scroll into place), price, SKU, availability; unavailable combos strike through live. URL updates per variant (shareable).
- **Mobile** — gallery carousel top; buy box flows below; **sticky bottom ATC bar** (glass, 64px: thumb + price + “Add to cart”) appears after the in-flow ATC scrolls away. Accordions collapsed except Description.
- **Micro-interactions** — gallery images fade-up 350ms staggered 60ms on entry; price crossfades on variant change (150ms); swatch selection ring animates in 150ms; accordion + rotates 45°.

8 · Collection Page

- **Banner** — compact 280px image with scrim + Marcellus title + optional 60ch description; or minimal text-only header (title + count). Tall banners waste the LCP viewport — compact is default.
- **Toolbar** — sticky under header, hairline top/bottom: “Filter” button (count chip when active) · active-filter chips with × (and “Clear all”) · product count · grid switcher (2/3/4 columns, icon toggle) · Sort select (Featured, Newest, Price ↑↓, Best selling).
- **Filters** — *desktop default*: 280px left sidebar, accordion groups (Availability, Price slider with histogram, Color swatch grid, Size chips, Material, Vendor), instant apply, results update with 250ms grid crossfade; *drawer mode* (setting): same content in a left drawer with sticky “Show 48 results” footer button — drawer is always the mobile behavior. Filter counts shown per option; zero-result options muted.
- **Grid** — 4/3/2 columns (desktop/tablet/mobile), 24px gaps (16 mobile). Optional editorial break tile (image card) every 8 products for brand texture.
- **Loading** — “Load more” button + count (default; preserves footer reachability and history). Infinite scroll optional with automatic sentinel + “Page 2” URL updates. Skeleton cards during fetch, never layout shift (aspect-ratio reserved).
- **Quick add** — single-variant: one tap adds with toast; multi-variant: bottom-sheet variant picker (mobile) / card-overlay picker (desktop).
- **Badges** — max 2 per card, priority: Sold out > Sale > New > custom (“Bestseller”).

9 · Checkout Styling (Shopify constraints)

- Checkout branding (via Shopify checkout editor): logo at 44px height; background #FAF9F7; buttons ink with 2px radius; Instrument Sans for all checkout type via Shopify font picker (fallback: Helvetica); accent color ink — bronze only for links.
- Order summary: product thumbs at 4px radius; discount tag in bronze.
- Progress: rely on Shopify’s breadcrumb, styled ink-on-muted — recommend one-page checkout layout where plan allows.
- Trust continuity: same footer microcopy (“Free returns within 30 days”) entered in checkout settings so the voice doesn’t break at the money step.

10 · Motion Design

Philosophy: Apple/Stripe/Linear physicality — fast starts, long soft landings, nothing elastic. Every animation answers “what changed?”; if it doesn’t, it’s cut.

Token	Value	Used for
duration-instant	120ms	Presses, toggles, checks
duration-fast	200ms	Hovers, underlines, fades
duration-base	300ms	Modals, accordions, tabs, dropdowns
duration-slow	450ms	Drawers, page reveals
duration-editorial	600-800ms	Image scale, Ken-Burns, parallax settle
ease-out (default)	cubic-bezier(0.22, 1, 0.36, 1)	Everything entering / expanding
ease-in-out	cubic-bezier(0.65, 0, 0.35, 1)	Crossfades, position swaps
ease-exit	cubic-bezier(0.4, 0, 1, 1) · 0.7× duration	Everything leaving (exits are faster than entries)

- **Scroll reveal** — sections fade-up 24px, 450ms, children staggered 60ms, triggered at 15% visibility, once. Only transform/opacity — no filter or layout animation.
- **Page transition** — 150ms fade-out → 250ms fade-in; hairline progress bar under header during fetch. No full-screen curtains.

- **Drawer** (cart/menu/filter) — translateX with duration-slow ease-out; scrim fades in parallel; content staggers 40ms after panel.
- **Modal** — scale 0.97→1 + fade, duration-base; exit 200ms.
- **Card hover** — image crossfade 350ms; lift = shadow interpolation, no translateY jumps.
- **Image zoom (hover-scale)** — 1.0→1.04 over 600ms inside clipped frame.
- **Parallax** — banners only, ±40px range, transform-only, disabled on mobile and reduced-motion.
- **Reduced motion** — prefers-reduced-motion collapses all motion to 80ms opacity fades; parallax/Ken-Burns/shimmer off. Mobile also drops parallax and staggers (battery).

11 · Premium Details

- Hairline everything — 1px borders at low contrast do the structural work shadows usually do; shadows are reserved for true elevation (floating layers).
- Optional paper-grain background texture (2% opacity tiled noise) on Card-tint sections — tactility without weight; off by default, one checkbox.
- Section dividers: 64px centered hairline (25% width) or a single bronze 4px diamond — used sparingly on editorial pages.
- Selection color: bronze at 20% — even text selection is on-brand.
- Hover glow: allowed only on primary CTA over dark imagery — 0 0 0→24px rgba(194,163,121,0.25), 300ms.
- Premium badge treatment: badges are typographic chips, never ribbons or starbursts.
- Image discipline: all product imagery on shared Card-tint ground; drop-shadowed cut-outs and mixed backgrounds are the fastest route to “cheap”.
- Custom thin-stroke iconography for trust rows (box, arrows-loop, shield, chat) rather than stock emoji-style icons.
- Beautiful empties and 404 (\$5.6) — the “nobody looks here” screens are where \$400 themes prove themselves.

12 · Accessibility & Performance

WCAG 2.2 AA

- All text pairs ≥ 4.5:1 (7.9:1 body); UI glyphs ≥ 3:1; verified in both modes

CORE WEB VITALS BUDGETS

- **LCP ≤ 2.0s** — hero image preloaded, fetchpriority=high, responsive srcset, AVIF/WebP; video heroes poster-first

- Full keyboard path: skip-link, logical tab order, focus trapped in overlays and returned on close
- Visible 2px bronze focus ring everywhere, ivory on dark surfaces
- ARIA: nav landmarks, aria-expanded on accordions/menus, aria-live on cart + form results, labeled icon buttons
- Hit targets $\geq 44\text{px}$; swatch selections always echoed as text; state never color-only
- Zoom to 200% without loss; drawers scroll internally
- Honors prefers-reduced-motion and prefers-color-scheme
- **CLS ≤ 0.05** — aspect-ratio on every image, metric-matched font fallbacks, fixed skeleton geometry, reserved announcement-bar height
- **INP $\leq 200\text{ms}$** — no main-thread animation; transform/opacity only; predictive search debounced + aborted
- Below-fold sections lazy; sliders/filters hydrate on interaction; DOM $\leq \sim 1,200$ nodes on templates
- Two font families / 3 weights total; icons as inline SVG sprite, no icon font
- “Performance mode” setting: disables parallax, Ken-Burns, hover-crossfade, shimmer globally

RESPONSIVE BEHAVIOR SUMMARY

- **1440+**: reference layout; 4-up grids, mega menu, sidebar filters, sticky buy box.
- **1280**: identical structure, gutters 48→40px, product grid stays 4-up (cards ~272px).
- **768**: grids 4→2-3 up; sidebar filters → drawer; mega menu → drawer nav; PDP still 2-column but 6/6; image-with-text stacks with image first.
- **390–430**: single column; PDP gallery becomes carousel; sticky ATC bar; toolbar condenses to Filter + Sort split buttons; type scale drops per clamp; section spacing 64–80px.

13 · Theme Settings Panel

Organized to mirror the merchant’s mental model, grouped exactly as below. Every control maps 1:1 to a design token — no orphan settings.

Colors — 5 color schemes (each: bg, surface, text, accent, button); status colors; dark-mode palette + toggle strategy (off / user toggle / follow system)

Layout — container width 1200–1600, section spacing scale 0.75–1.25 $\times$, grid gap

Buttons — style (solid/outline), hover effect (darken/fill/underline), shadow on/off

Announcement bar — messages, rotation, dismissible, scheme

Typography — display + body font pickers, base size 14–17, scale ratio 1.15–1.30, caps-buttons toggle, letter-spacing

Corners — radius sliders: buttons 0–999, cards 0–24, inputs 0–999, images 0–24

Header — layout (logo left/center), transparent-on-home, sticky mode (always/on-scroll-up/off), mega menu per item, search style

Product cards — ratio (3:4/4:5/1:1), second-image hover, quick add style, vendor/rating show, badge

Collection cards — overlay vs below-text, ratio, count display

Badges — sale format (% , amount, “Sale”), colors per badge

Newsletter — provider, incentive copy, popup rules (delay/scroll/exit, frequency)

Animations — master toggle, scroll reveals, hover effects, parallax, performance mode

Advanced — custom CSS box, custom head code, performance mode, image loading strategy

config + custom badges

Cart — drawer vs page, free-shipping threshold + messages, upsell source (manual/AI), gift wrap product, notes

Blog — card style, sidebar on/off, author/date display

Social — platform links, icon style (line/solid), share buttons

Footer — scheme, columns, newsletter, payment icons, locale selectors

14 · Design Tokens

Single source of truth as CSS custom properties on `:root`, remapped under `[data-theme="dark"]`. Settings write to tokens; components read only tokens.

```
--color-bg: #FAF9F7      --color-surface: #FFFFFF      --color-card: #F3F1EC
--color-border: #E7E3DC  --color-ink: #1C1B18          --color-text-2: #57534A
--color-muted: #8A857B   --color-accent: #8A6D4B      --color-accent-2: #5C6F5E
--color-success: #2E7D5B --color-warning: #A66A1F    --color-error: #B3402E
--color-info: #3B6EA5    --color-overlay: rgba(28,27,24,.45)

--space-1...11: 4 8 12 16 24 32 48 64 96 128 160 (px)
--radius-btn: 2px --radius-sm: 4px --radius-md: 8px --radius-pill: 999px
--shadow-sm/md/lg/float/modal: ($4)
--font-display: 'Marcellus' --font-body: 'Instrument Sans'
--text-h1: clamp(2.5rem, 5vw, 4rem) ... --text-caption: 0.6875rem (full scale §3)
--track-caps: .12em --track-kicker: .16em

--dur-instant: 120ms --dur-fast: 200ms --dur-base: 300ms
--dur-slow: 450ms --dur-editorial: 600ms
--ease-out: cubic-bezier(.22,1,.36,1) --ease-in-out: cubic-bezier(.65,0,.35,1)
--ease-exit: cubic-bezier(.4,0,1,1)

--z-base:0 --z-sticky:100 --z-header:200 --z-dropdown:300
--z-drawer:400 --z-modal:500 --z-toast:600 --z-cookie:350
```

```
--opacity-disabled:.4 --opacity-muted-media:.6 --opacity-logo:.45  
--transition-default: all var(--dur-fast) var(--ease-out)
```

15 · Future AI-Powered Features

- **Semantic search** — natural-language predictive search (“linen dress for a summer wedding”) with the same result-panel design as §5.1.
- **AI stylist / “Complete the look”** — recommendation slots (PDP bundle, cart upsell) designed source-agnostic so an AI ranker can fill them without UI change.
- **Conversational concierge** — bottom-right ghost chip (“Ask us anything”), opens quiet Surface panel matching drawer anatomy; answers grounded in product metafields + policies.
- **AI size guidance** — “Find my size” beside size chips: 3-question sheet returning a recommended chip pre-selected with confidence copy.
- **Generative merchandising** — section settings accept “auto” content (headlines, collection descriptions) with merchant approval flow; typography system already tolerates variable-length copy (clamp + balance).
- **Personalized order** — homepage section order re-rankable per visitor segment; sections are self-contained so re-ordering is safe by design.

16 · Implementation Notes for Claude Code

- **Architecture** — Shopify Online Store 2.0: JSON templates, sections everywhere, blocks within sections. No jQuery, no framework — vanilla ES modules + Web Components for interactive islands (cart-drawer, predictive-search, variant-picker, quantity-input, mega-menu, product-gallery, filter-panel, accordion-group).
- **Token layer first** — implement §14 as `snippets/theme-tokens.liquid` emitting CSS custom properties from `settings_schema`. Every component consumes tokens only; dark mode = one attribute swap on `html`.
- **Component hierarchy** — `layout/theme.liquid` → sections (header-group, template sections, footer-group) → snippets (product-card, price, badge, icon, skeleton) — snippets are the design-system atoms; cards must render identically in grids, sliders, search results, and recommendations.
- **State management** — cart via Section Rendering API (fetch + morph, aria-live announcements); variant state in URL params; wishlist/compare/recently-viewed in `localStorage` with graceful empty states.

- **Motion** — one shared `motion.js`: IntersectionObserver reveal, drawer/modal controller with focus trap, reduced-motion + performance-mode gates. All durations/easings read from tokens.
- **Images** — a single `responsive-image.liquid` snippet: srcset ladder 360–2048, aspect-ratio box, lazy except first section, Card-tint placeholder background.
- **Order of build** — tokens → typography/base → buttons/forms → product card → header/nav → PDP → collection → cart drawer → homepage sections → system states → settings schema polish.
- **Definition of done per component** — all seven states (\$5 contract), both color modes, 390/768/1440 verified, keyboard path tested, zero CLS, tokens-only styling.

Atelier · Design Specification v1.0 · Every value in this document is normative unless marked optional.
Deviations during implementation should be resolved in favor of restraint.